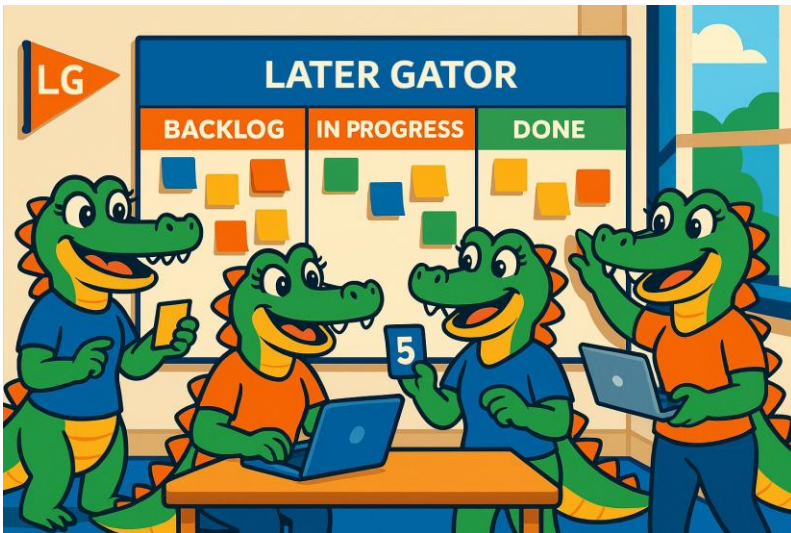




LATER GATOR

PRODUCT BACKLOG

PREPARED FOR

CEN3031 – Introduction to Software Engineering

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PRODUCT BACKLOG

This artifact demonstrates the team's understanding of how to create, estimate, and prioritize a Product Backlog using Agile Scrum principles. While the **Later Gator** app is a conceptual product, this process allowed the team to practice translating user stories into backlog items, applying story point estimation, and collaboratively determining priorities and ownership.

After completing our user stories, the team met to translate them into specific Product Backlog Items (PBIs). Each item represented a distinct feature, enhancement, or technical task that would contribute to the overall functionality of the app. As a group, we discussed how to break down large concepts into manageable tasks and identified initial priorities for each item. This collaborative effort helped ensure that all members shared a common understanding of the product scope and the work ahead.

Planning Poker

To estimate the relative effort of each backlog item, our Product Manager introduced the Planning Poker Online app by *We Agile You*¹, which is also available as a Jira plugin. Our Scrum Master ensured the integration worked properly and imported the full list of PBIs into the session. This list can be seen in Appendix A.

At first, team members had different interpretations of task complexity, which led to wide variation in story point estimates. Through discussions during the Planning Poker rounds, the team began to understand how aspects such as interface design, database setup, and feature logic each carried different levels of effort. These conversations helped establish a shared definition of what "one story point" represents within the context of Scrum and the bounds of our team's capacity. Ultimately, the team agreed to define one story point as approximately one hour of focused development time, taking into account complexity, uncertainty, and expected collaboration.

When initial estimates varied significantly amongst members, members explained their reasoning before another round of voting, allowing the group to reach consensus.

As a result of this exercise, the team developed a clearer understanding of the project's overall scope and dependencies. The Product Manager and Scrum Master ensured that course deliverables and immediate milestones were reflected in the backlog, while the development team balanced priorities across both user interface and functional components.

See Appendix B for visuals of the Planning Poker session.

¹ <https://planningpokeronline.com/>

Initial Grooming

Following the Planning Poker session, the team reviewed and refined the estimated backlog items. Each member identified tasks they felt most confident or motivated to lead, while also suggesting opportunities for pair programming to promote shared learning and collaboration.

During this session, the team also revisited task dependencies and clarified acceptance criteria for the higher-priority items. These refinements helped ensure that the backlog aligned with both the immediate course deliverables and the broader vision for the **Later Gator** app.

The refined backlog emphasized minimum viable product (MVP) features that would make the app functional and testable early in development, while also capturing several potential enhancements for future sprints. Because none of the team members has prior experience developing a full mobile application, backlog items were intentionally kept small, descriptive, and achievable, allowing the team to maintain momentum while learning new tools and frameworks along the way.

In addition, two foundational deliverables, Design Wireframes and Architecture Diagrams, will be completed collaboratively by the entire team rather than assigned individually. These items are intentionally left unassigned in Jira to represent shared ownership and cross-functional participation. Completing these tasks together will allow the team to develop a unified understanding of both the overall system architecture and the intended user experience before dividing responsibilities for individual components. This shared foundation is expected to enhance coordination, clarify dependencies, and improve the quality of work in later development stages.

See Appendix C for the refined backlog view.

NEXT STEPS

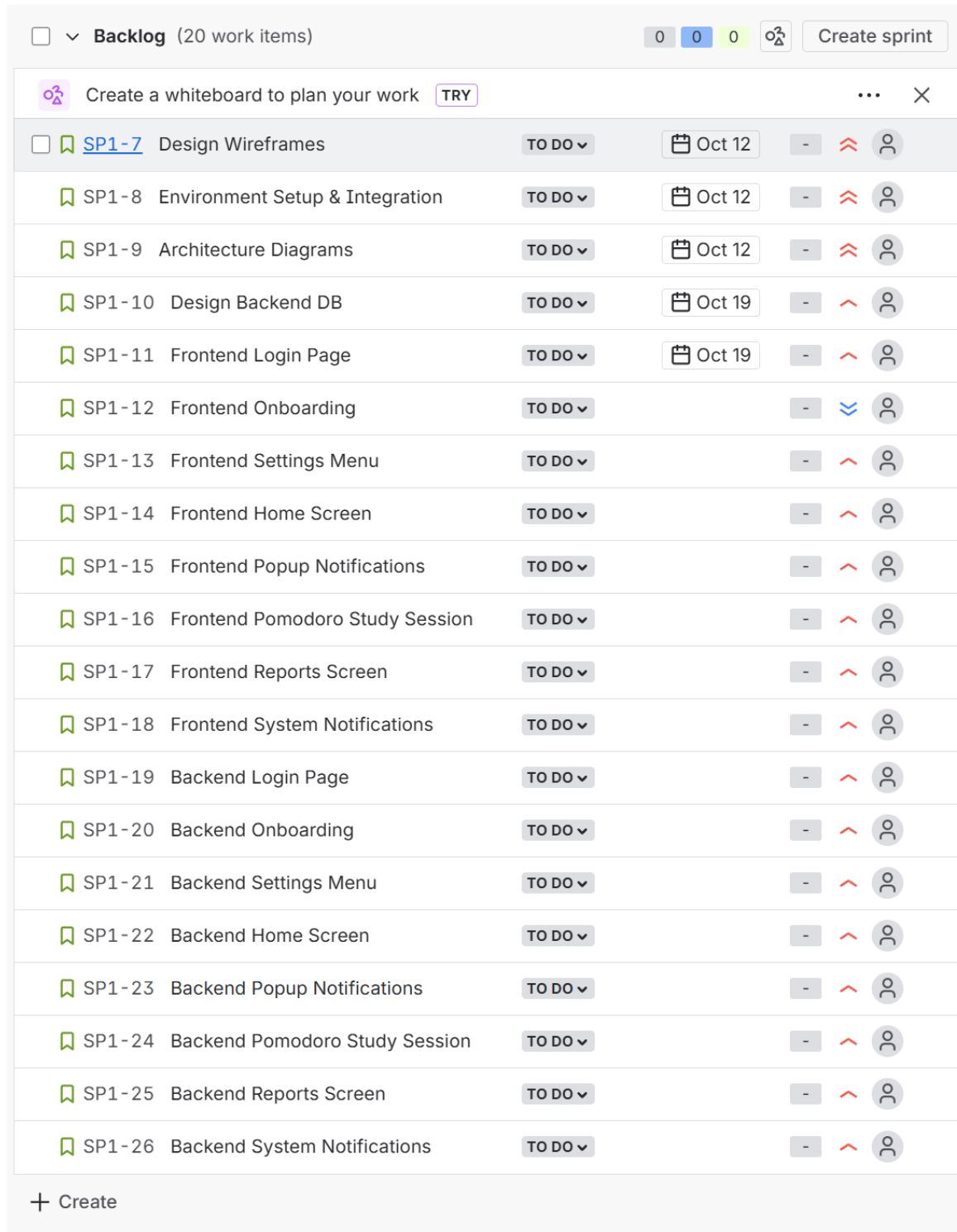
Through the process of backlog creation, estimation, and refinement, the team developed a clearer understanding of how individual contributions fit within the Agile framework. Each stage, identifying Product Backlog Items, assigning story points, and grooming the backlog, helped build a shared sense of ownership and accountability.

The team has organized the current backlog into Sprint 1 and Sprint 2, while a few lower-priority items remain in the general backlog for future consideration. This initial distribution reflects our best understanding of priorities, dependencies, and workload balance at this stage of development. As we progress, we expect these allocations to evolve through regular sprint reviews and retrospectives.

In the coming weeks, we will use these sprints to begin implementing features, track team velocity, and refine our processes based on what we learn about effort estimation, collaboration, and task management in practice.

APPENDIX

A. Backlog Creation



Backlog (20 work items)

Create sprint

Create a whiteboard to plan your work TRY

ID	Task Name	Status	Due Date	Priority	Assignee
SP1-7	Design Wireframes	TO DO	Oct 12	-	
SP1-8	Environment Setup & Integration	TO DO	Oct 12	-	
SP1-9	Architecture Diagrams	TO DO	Oct 12	-	
SP1-10	Design Backend DB	TO DO	Oct 19	-	
SP1-11	Frontend Login Page	TO DO	Oct 19	-	
SP1-12	Frontend Onboarding	TO DO		-	
SP1-13	Frontend Settings Menu	TO DO		-	
SP1-14	Frontend Home Screen	TO DO		-	
SP1-15	Frontend Popup Notifications	TO DO		-	
SP1-16	Frontend Pomodoro Study Session	TO DO		-	
SP1-17	Frontend Reports Screen	TO DO		-	
SP1-18	Frontend System Notifications	TO DO		-	
SP1-19	Backend Login Page	TO DO		-	
SP1-20	Backend Onboarding	TO DO		-	
SP1-21	Backend Settings Menu	TO DO		-	
SP1-22	Backend Home Screen	TO DO		-	
SP1-23	Backend Popup Notifications	TO DO		-	
SP1-24	Backend Pomodoro Study Session	TO DO		-	
SP1-25	Backend Reports Screen	TO DO		-	
SP1-26	Backend System Notifications	TO DO		-	

+ Create

Figure A: The team's initial list of known Product Backlog Items created directly from the user stories. This snapshot shows the first attempt at breaking down the app into discrete, actionable tasks prior to estimation.

B. Poker Planning

SP1-14 Frontend Home Screen

< Voting1/1 ⓘ >

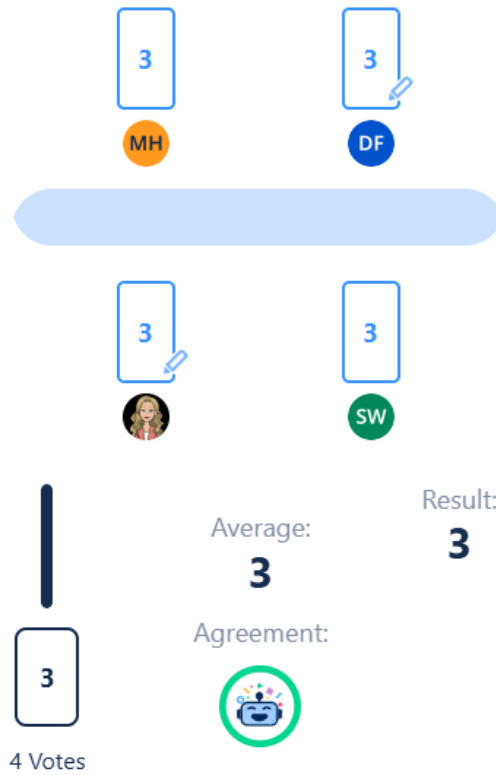


Figure B1. Planning Poker Online in Jira. Each team member independently estimated the effort for each backlog item before discussing differences and reaching consensus.

SP1-8 Environment Setup & Integration

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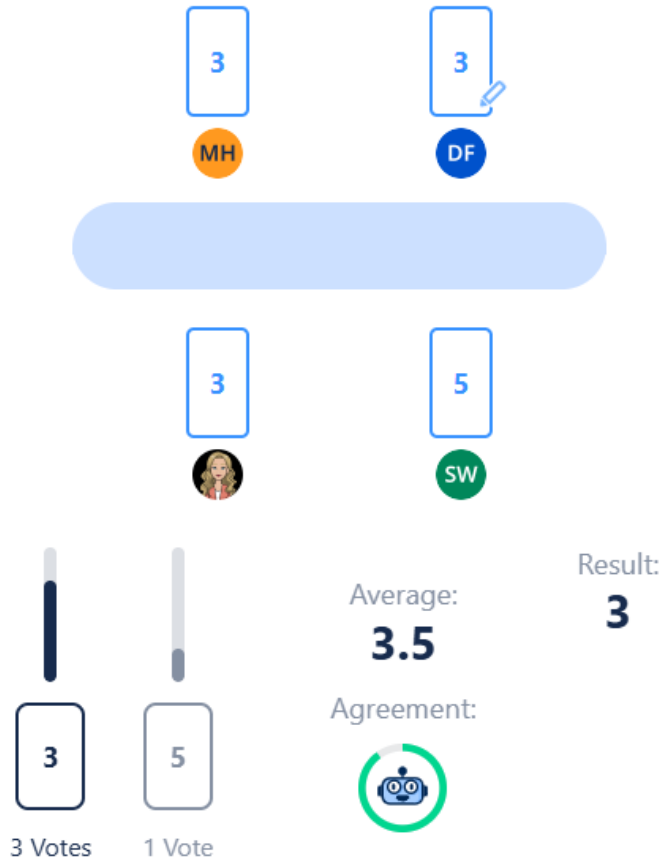


Figure B2. Example of the consensus round where varied story point estimates were discussed and finalized. The activity helped the team align on what “one story point” represents within our project.

C. Groomed Backlog

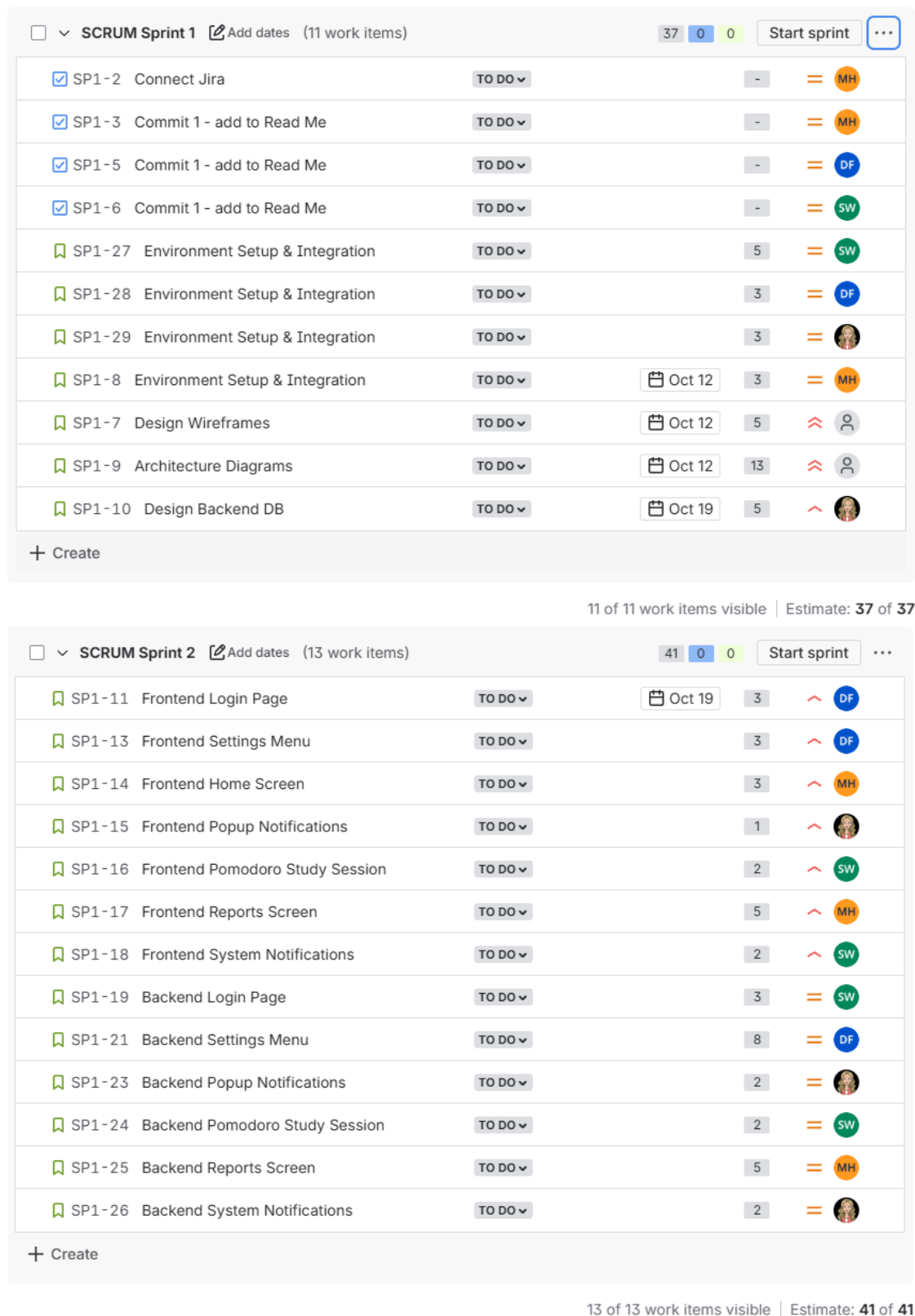


Figure C1. The refined and prioritized backlog after estimation and grooming. Items are organized by sprint, with core MVP features scheduled for Sprint 1 and additional enhancements for Sprint 2 and beyond.

☐ **Backlog** (2 work items)

800

Create sprint

SP1-12 Frontend Onboarding	TO DO	5		SW
SP1-20 Backend Onboarding	TO DO	3		

+ Create

Figure C2. The remaining items currently left in the general backlog. These represent lower-priority or future enhancements that may be incorporated in later sprints as team capacity and priorities evolve.